BOOK ONE

CHAPTER 4

THE EMPTY THRONE

No neck for a crown

SEALED

Open only when the table begins this chapter.

Book One · Chapter 4: The Empty Throne (No neck for a crown)

No card table to shut down. No leader to arrest. The only way to win is for everybody to read.

Setup

Set up the Full Block (Co-op), with the Terrell rule and endless deals. The Owner is The Empty Throne (it plays as The Algorithm): slide its card face-down under the board instead of shuffling the Owners. Ignore the scenario deck.

The twist

Full Block with endless deals. No neck for a crown: you can't Expose the Owner until every player has taught at least once, and while any one player holds more than half the table's Props.

The Owner's face

The Empty Throne: no face at all, just the system. Relentless: the Machine strikes one extra time every round.

Ending the chapter

The book's last scene is on a porch. If you won, read it aloud.

Balance-tested with computer players at 1–5 players (python3 balance_test.py, CAMPAIGNS and SOLO). Solo: 5 actions, Teach a neighbor, trace 2 threads (RULES.md, Solo).

THE OWNER hidden

The Empty Throne

The Empty Throne: no face at all, just the system. Relentless: the Machine strikes one extra time every round.

This chapter's Owner. Slide it face-down under the board instead of shuffling the Owners.

THE TWIST Chapter 4

The Empty Throne

Full Block with endless deals. No neck for a crown: you can't Expose the Owner until every player has taught at least once, and while any one player holds more than half the table's Props.

NO NECK FOR A CROWN Expose

The Empty Throne

You can't Expose the Owner until every player has taught at least once, and not while any one player holds more than half of the table's Props.

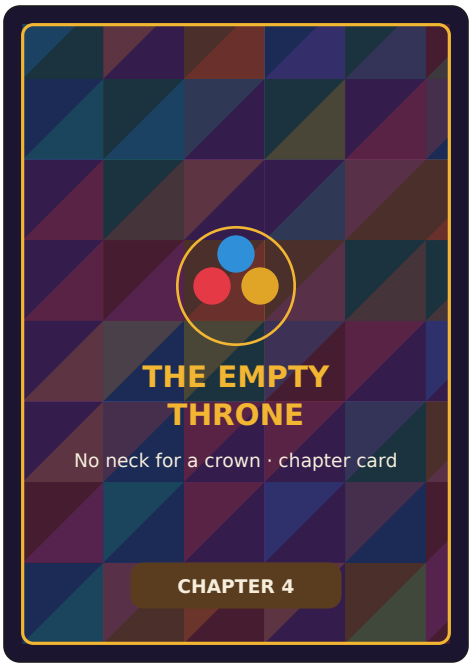
Taught: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

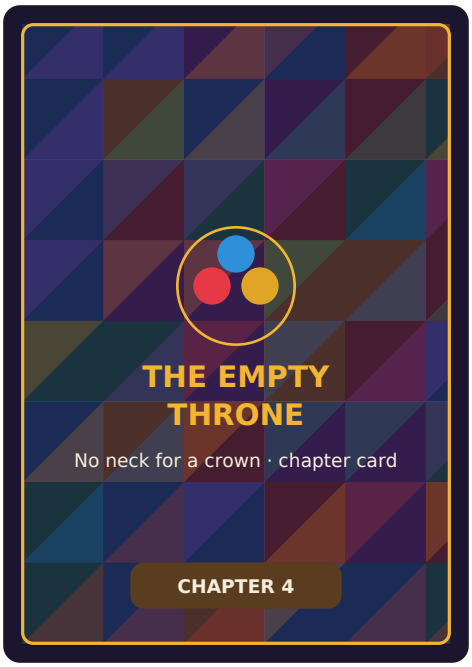
BOOK ONE after the chapter

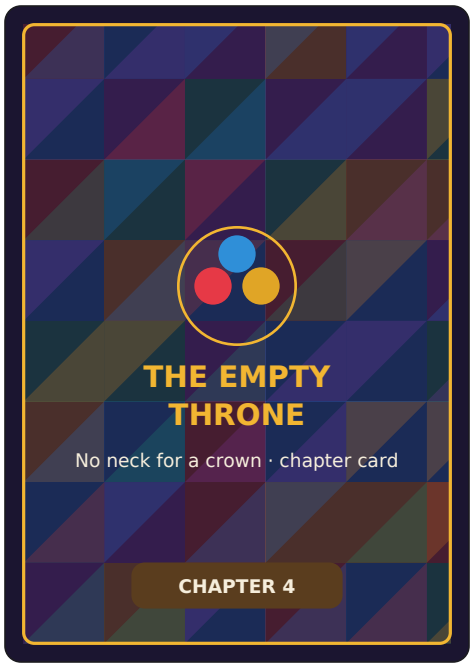
What It Writes Down

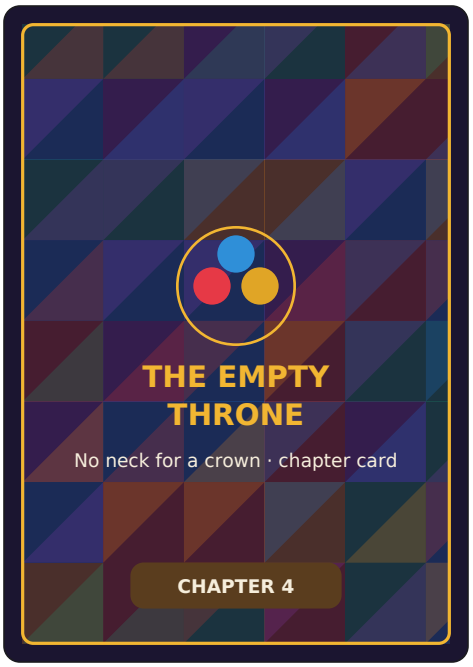
The book's last scene is on a porch. If you won, read it aloud.


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No neck for a crown · chapter card
CHAPTER 4


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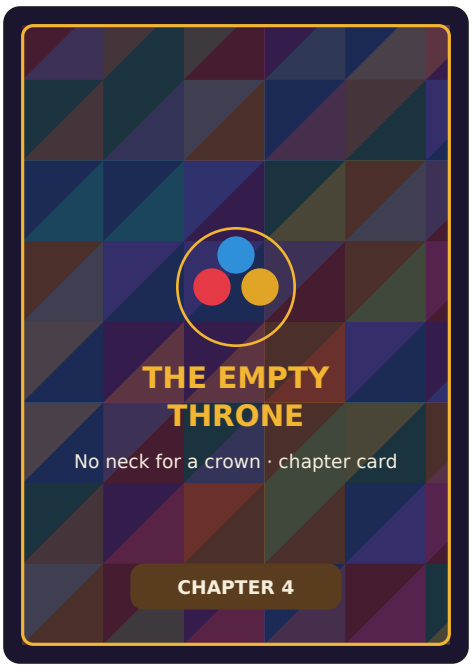

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